

- AND operator "&", OR operator "|", XOR operator "^"
- equal "==", not equal "!="

If an expression is false, there SHALL be no assumption of general optionality. If the conformance expression evaluates to false but optional, the expression is false.

Some examples of conformance definitions:

- "[AB]" means the element is not allowed, if AB evaluates to false.
- "[AA & BB]" means optional if AA and BB are both true, but excluded (and not optional) otherwise.
- "[!AA & BB]" means only optional if AA is false and BB is true.

7.3.14. Choice Conformance

Choice conformance defines requirements for implementing a set of elements at the same level. This set of elements is called the choice set.

Choice parameters determine the requirements for a choice set and are added to a conformance expression following a period, for example *C.an+*.

C is any logical optional *[AB]* conformance expression or optional conformance list, including "O" (optional), but not "M", "X", "D", or "P". If *C* is a conformance list, then the list SHALL be surrounded by parentheses. A conformance list may also include optional choice expressions among others in the list that do not support a choice.

It is invalid to use mandatory conformance for choice such as "M.a", "AB.a+" or "!AB.a-". This gives the reader the false impression that the individual element is mandatory.

The choice parameters are *a*, *n*, "+" (plus sign) and "-" (minus sign):

- *a* is a lower case letter identifying 2 or more elements in the choice set, that SHALL be at the same scope (in the same table).
- *n* determines the number from the choice set that SHALL be supported after evaluation of the conformance *C* and subject to the conditions described below. *n* SHALL only be present as a suffix to a choice set.
- + and - serve to limit the number of elements that may be included from the choice set in an implementation and SHALL only be present as a suffix to *n* or to the choice set if *n* is omitted. These choice parameters SHALL NOT appear together in the same conformance designation.

The *n*, +, and - choice parameters, if present, are interpreted as follows:

- If *n* is omitted, then *n* is considered to be one.
- If *n* appears without a plus ("+") or minus ("-") sign choice parameter, *n* represents the exact number of elements from the choice set that SHALL be included in an implementation. *n* SHALL be between 1 and the number of elements in the choice set minus 1.
- If *n* appears with a plus ("+") sign choice parameter, *n* represents that at least *n* elements of the